



SARAH L. VOISIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

The funeral procession carrying the casket of former president Jimmy Carter passes the U.S. Capitol, where he will lie in state.

Celebrating a ‘servant of the people’

As Carter arrives in Washington, many gather to honor his humility and decency

BY PAUL KANE,
OLIVIA GEORGE,
JOE HEIM
AND PAUL DUGGAN

The casket bearing America’s longest-living former president, Jimmy Carter, arrived in D.C. on Tuesday after a weekend of memorial events in his native Georgia and was carried in a horse-drawn caisson to the U.S. Capitol,

where his body will lie in state in the Rotunda ahead of a grand funeral set for Thursday at Washington National Cathedral.

With a storm just passed and snow blanketing the region, scores of onlookers flanked Pennsylvania Avenue NW, bathed in icy air and waning sunshine, as a military procession escorted the caisson up Capitol Hill from the U.S. Navy Me-

morial — a mile-long solemn march that recalled a walk of triumph by the 39th president on a similarly cold and bright afternoon nearly half a century ago.

Clara Sachs, a Marylander who is “old enough for Medicare,” stood along Pennsylvania Avenue, clutching a big American flag as the caisson rolled past. She was in college during

Carter’s single White House term. “After the debacle of Watergate and Nixon, it was so refreshing and reassuring to have a president with such strong principles and humility,” she recalled through tears, describing Carter as “such a servant of the people.”

Carter, who died Dec. 29 at 100, brought a peanut farmer’s common-folk ethos to Washington in

SEE CARTER ON A10

Raging wildfire forces thousands to evacuate L.A.

BY BRIANNA SACKS,
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JOSHUA PARTLOW
AND BRADY DENNIS

LOS ANGELES — A furious, wind-whipped wildfire tore through hills on the west side of the city on Tuesday, torching homes and vehicles and forcing thousands to evacuate the coastal Pacific Palisades neighborhood. The region, which has not seen significant

Strong winds fuel flames in area that’s had months without significant rain

rain since spring, had been bracing for flames in conditions ripe for fire.

By the afternoon, the fire had raced across more than 1,200

acres as smoke billowed off the foothills and blackened the skies over Los Angeles, fanned by blasting Santa Ana winds that were expected to continue into the rest of the week. The evacuation forced a panicked scramble and massive gridlock as dozens of vehicles were abandoned on Sunset Boulevard and other thoroughfares, forcing authorities to bulldoze them off the roads to free up traffic.

Los Angeles Fire Department officials said the blaze, known as the Palisades Fire, threatened more than 10,000 structures and forced the evacuation of some 30,000 people. Southern California Edison, which provides electricity to some 5 million customers in the region, cut off power as an emergency safety measure to more than 7,600 customers in Los Angeles and Ventura counties as

SEE FIRE ON A20

Zuckerberg cites a ‘cultural tipping point’ triggered by the election

BY NAOMI NIX,
WILL OREMUS
AND AARON GREGG

Meta will dismantle its extensive fact-checking program in the United States, chief executive Mark Zuckerberg said Tuesday, ending a practice that has sought to limit the spread of falsehoods on its platforms but has been assailed as censorship in conservative circles.

The company said it would allow its users to add context or debunk claims in notes that appear next to specific posts, a process pioneered by Elon Musk’s X. Meta will also lift restrictions on hot-button topics, such as immigration and gender identity, to focus on illegal or high-severity violations.

The announcement was accompanied by sweeping changes to Meta’s community guidelines, allowing for greater critiques of LGBTQ+ people and other marginalized groups. New rules allow posts calling for gender-based restrictions in bathrooms, sports and specific schools, or for characterizing homosexuality as a mental

SEE META ON A16

Palestinians brace for ban on lifeline agency

New laws to crack down on UNRWA, which Israel alleges has ties to Oct. 7

BY RUBY MELLEN
AND HEIDI LEVINE

QALANDIA CAMP, WEST BANK — The U.N. agency that provides aid and services to millions of Palestinians across the Middle East may soon be forced to end its operations in the West Bank and Gaza Strip, as Israel prepares to enact twin laws banning the organization’s work in Israeli territory and prohibiting contact between its staff and government officials.

The legislation, passed with near-unanimity by Israel’s Knesset in October, is set to go into effect later this month. It could compel the United Nations Relief and Works Agency (UNRWA) to dismantle what is essentially a

quasi-state in the Palestinian territories, built over generations to serve a growing population of refugees and their descendants.

Israel has already taken significant steps to handicap UNRWA’s operations in Gaza, where it alleged last year that 19 of the agency’s 13,000 workers participated in the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks. An internal U.N. investigation found in August that nine of the accused “may have been involved” and that Israel provided insufficient or no evidence for the other cases.

Still, Israel has restricted aid deliveries and damaged or destroyed hundreds of the agency’s buildings in strikes the military says targeted Hamas.

Now, there are fears that the agency could be crippled by a similar crackdown in the West Bank and East Jerusalem, where together it provides employment, education, health care and sanitation services to more than

SEE PALESTINIANS ON A13



AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A declaration of genocide

People displaced by conflict in Sudan take a bus back home to a southern city from the country’s northeast. In a departure from previous policy, the United States said the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces is committing genocide and imposed sanctions on its leader. **Story, A12**

A return shipment from Mars is still in limbo

BY JOEL ACHENBACH

For more than a year, scientists and aerospace engineers have been awaiting NASA’s decision on how to rescue the troubled Mars Sample Return mission, which aspires to bring Martian rocks and soil to Earth but was halted amid dismay over the project’s cost and glacial timeline. It’s NASA’s most ambitious planetary science mission, a deep scouring of the history of Mars, and it conceivably could make the ultimate scientific breakthrough, detecting the first evidence of extraterrestrial life.

Finally, after months of pondering how to get samples to Earth faster and more simply, NASA on Tuesday announced its decision — which is to keep its options open. The agency said it has decided to study two distinct

SEE MARS ON A20

IN THE NEWS

Peter Yarrow, 1938-2025 The troubadour of the folk trio Peter, Paul and Mary saw his reputation tarnished when he pleaded guilty to a morals charge involving a minor. **B3**

Jean-Marie Le Pen, 1928-2025 The father of a far-right party in France was later expelled over views deemed racist and antisemitic. **B4**

THE NATION **Kidney stones**, once mostly a woe of middle-aged White men, are showing up in youths. **A3** **A judge** temporarily blocked the release of a special counsel report on Donald Trump. **A6**

THE WORLD **Justin Trudeau’s** tenure was marked first by charisma, then scandal and discontent. **A8** **An earthquake** killed at least 95 people in Tibet near China’s border with Nepal. **A9**

THE ECONOMY **The U.S. government** issued new rules to remove roughly \$49 billion in unpaid medical debts from Americans’ credit reports. **A14** **McDonald’s** will end several DEI initiatives, joining other high-profile companies in scaling back diversity goals. **A15**

THE REGION **Richmond’s water** supply was knocked out after a power failure at a city facility brought on by the winter storm. **B1** **The Virginia** General will briefly convene Wednesday, but the water shortage in Richmond will delay the session until Monday. **B1**

STYLE **Pre-ceremony** interviews on the red carpet have changed tune, with the question “Who are you wearing?” falling by the wayside. **C1**

FOOD **Protein is** an essential macronutrient, but how much do you really need to eat? **E1**

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